

Sonification Canvas

0 CHOOSE A DATASET

☐ free, no login ☐ structured (JSON / CSV) ☐ has real change, not just one number

Need a quick pick: earthquakes (USGS) · Wikipedia edits · weather (Open-Meteo) · GitHub events · crypto prices · air quality (OpenAQ)

1 DATA

Source _____

What changes in it _____

How often / in what pattern _____

2 STORY – WHAT SHOULD THE AUDIENCE FEEL AND SEE

BASELINE STATE
the normal, resting state

DISRUPTION / EVENT STATE
when the data breaks the baseline

3 VISUAL ↔ SOUND PARALLEL – WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW

VISUAL PRINCIPLE	SOUND EQUIVALENT	TOOL (SOUND / IMAGE)
Contrast (dark / light)	Dynamics, clarity	quiet–loud, clean–distorted / black&white–colour
Rhythm, grid, pattern	Tempo, repetition	beat, delay / visual pulsing
Hierarchy (what the eye sees first)	What the ear notices first	foreground–background volume / focus–blur
Tension, balance	Consonant ↔ dissonant	interval choice / symmetry–asymmetry
Colour temperature	Timbre warmth	analogue–digital / warm–cool palette
Texture (smooth ↔ grainy)	Amount of noise, distortion	bitcrush, static noise / grain, noise overlay
Space, negative space	Reverb, silence	reverb depth / how much air is in the composition
Motion (static ↔ dynamic)	Glide, displacement	pitch-glide, stereo movement / camera move, glitch

4 MAPPING – CONNECT THE DATA TO THE EFFECT

DATA CHANGE	SOUND EFFECT	VISUAL EFFECT	WHY IT FITS THE STORY